

Topic B Is dreaming meaningful?

1. Explaining the question: Is dreaming meaningful?

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a Freud's (1900) dream theory including the concepts of manifest content, latent content and dreamwork (displacement, condensation and secondary elaboration), and their evaluation of the theory
- b the basic structure and function of a neuron: axon, impulse, neurotransmitter, synaptic transmission
- c Hobson and McCarley's (1977) activation-synthesis model including the concepts of random activation, sensory blockade and movement inhibition
- d explanations of dreaming offered by Freud, and Hobson and McCarley, by comparing and evaluating them.

In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.

2. Investigating the question: Case studies

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the following terms, and their use when referring to methodology
 - i aim
 - ii case study
 - iii qualitative data
 - iv quantitative data
 - v privacy
 - vi confidentiality
 - vii generalisability
 - viii reliability
 - ix subjectivity and objectivity

Students could be asked to design a study from stimulus material, drawing on the terms above.

- b the ethical issues in case studies of humans of privacy and confidentiality and how they can be dealt with. (NB: The ethics of animal studies are discussed in Topic D.)
- c the case study as a research method including evaluation
- d the dream analysis of Little Hans in Freud (1909) *Analysis of a phobia of a five-year old boy* including evaluation of dream analysis as a research method.

3. Why psychology matters

Students will be assessed on their understanding of:

- a the role of the psychoanalyst including:
 - i who they might work for
 - ii what they do
 - iii skills required
 - iv qualifications required
 - v accreditation status
 - vi how they might use dream analysis to help someone.
- b how psychological sleep disorders (including REM sleep disorder) are treated at a sleep disorder clinic.

Note: In the examination, students could be asked to demonstrate their understanding of stimulus material drawing on key terms and explanations.